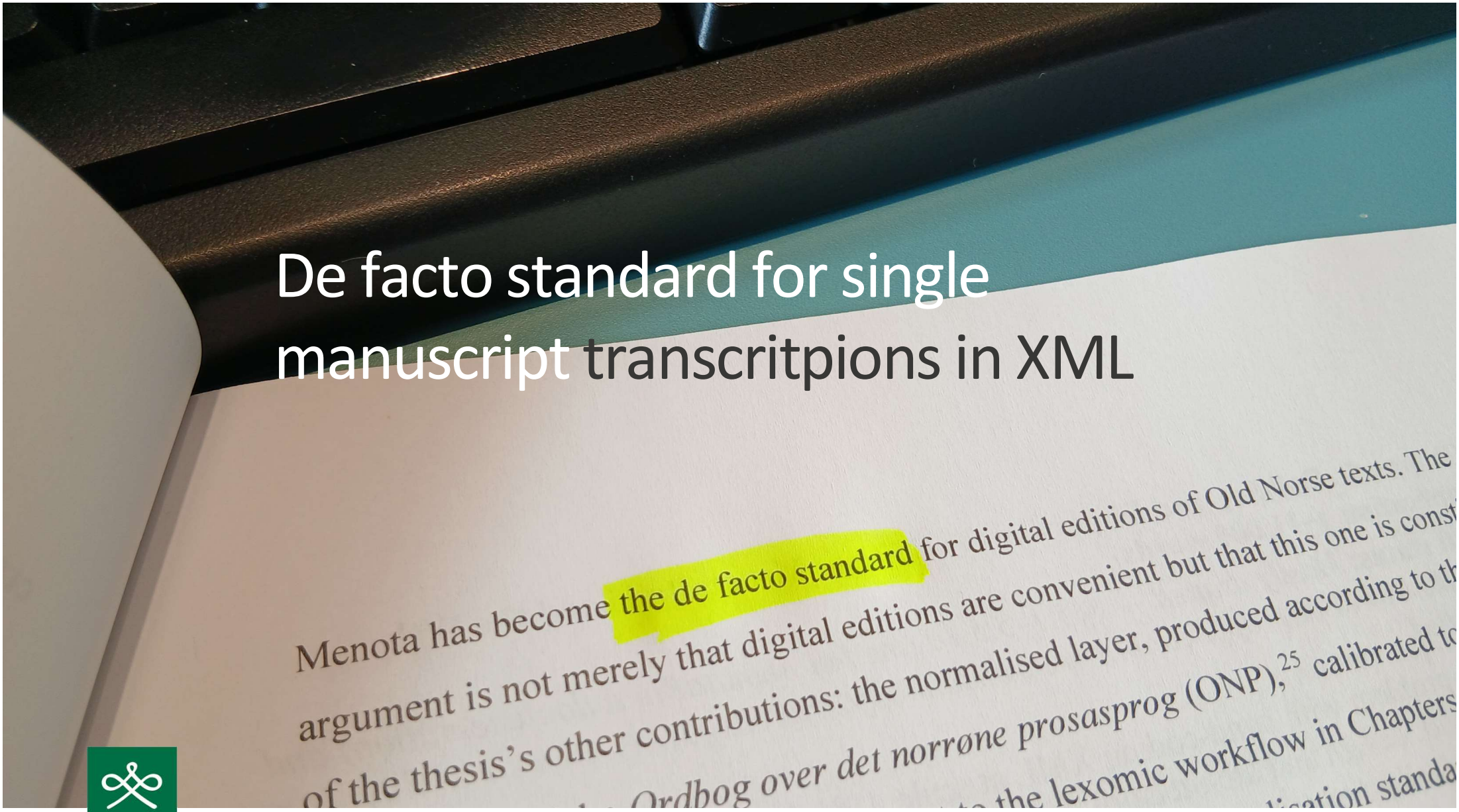
Árnastofnun

Reykjavík, 10 September 2026

Menota’s role in Old Norse Studies

Beeke Stegmann

Medieval Nordic Text Archive
www.menota.org


De facto standard for single manuscript transcritpions in XML
Menota has become the de facto standard for digital editions of Old Norse texts. The
argument is not merely that digital editions are convenient but that this one is const
of the thesis's other contributions: the normalised layer, produced according to th
Ordbog over det norrøne prosasprog (ONP),[25] calibrated to
the lexomic workflow in Chapters

Current status of archive

91 published transcriptions of manuscript texts

- comprising more than **2.124.041** words

32 of the 91 texts fully annotated

Medieval Nordic Text Archive
www.menota.org

Signature	Document	Main Editor(s)	Annotation	Version	Date	Lang.	Words	Lemma	Form	Facs	Dipl	Norm
AM 28 8vo	Codex Runicus	Paola Peratello	Paola Peratello	1.0	c. 1300	dan	16,947	completely	partly	yes	yes	
AM 35 fol	Heimskringla 1	Jon Gunnar Jørgensen		1.1	c. 1700	isl	68,573	none	none		yes	
AM 36 fol	Heimskringla 2	Kjartan Ottosson		1.0	c. 1700	isl	105,532	none	none		yes	
AM 56 4to	Landslǫg Magnúss Hákonarsonar | Magnus Lagabøtes landslov	Anna C. Horn		0.9.7	c. 1300	nor	49,256	none	none	yes	yes	
AM 60 4to	Kristinréttir, Landslǫg Magnúss Hákonarsonar, Bǿjarlǫg Magnúss	Anna C. Horn		0.9.9	c. 1320	nor	87,387	none	none	yes		

Scrolling through all 91 texts in main archive

Current status of archive

91 texts in main archive

196 charters

100 runic inscriptions (+ 1 manuscript in runes)

7 (partial) translations

Current status of archive

91 texts in main archive

196 charters

100 runic inscriptions (+ 1 manuscript in runes)

7 (partial) translations

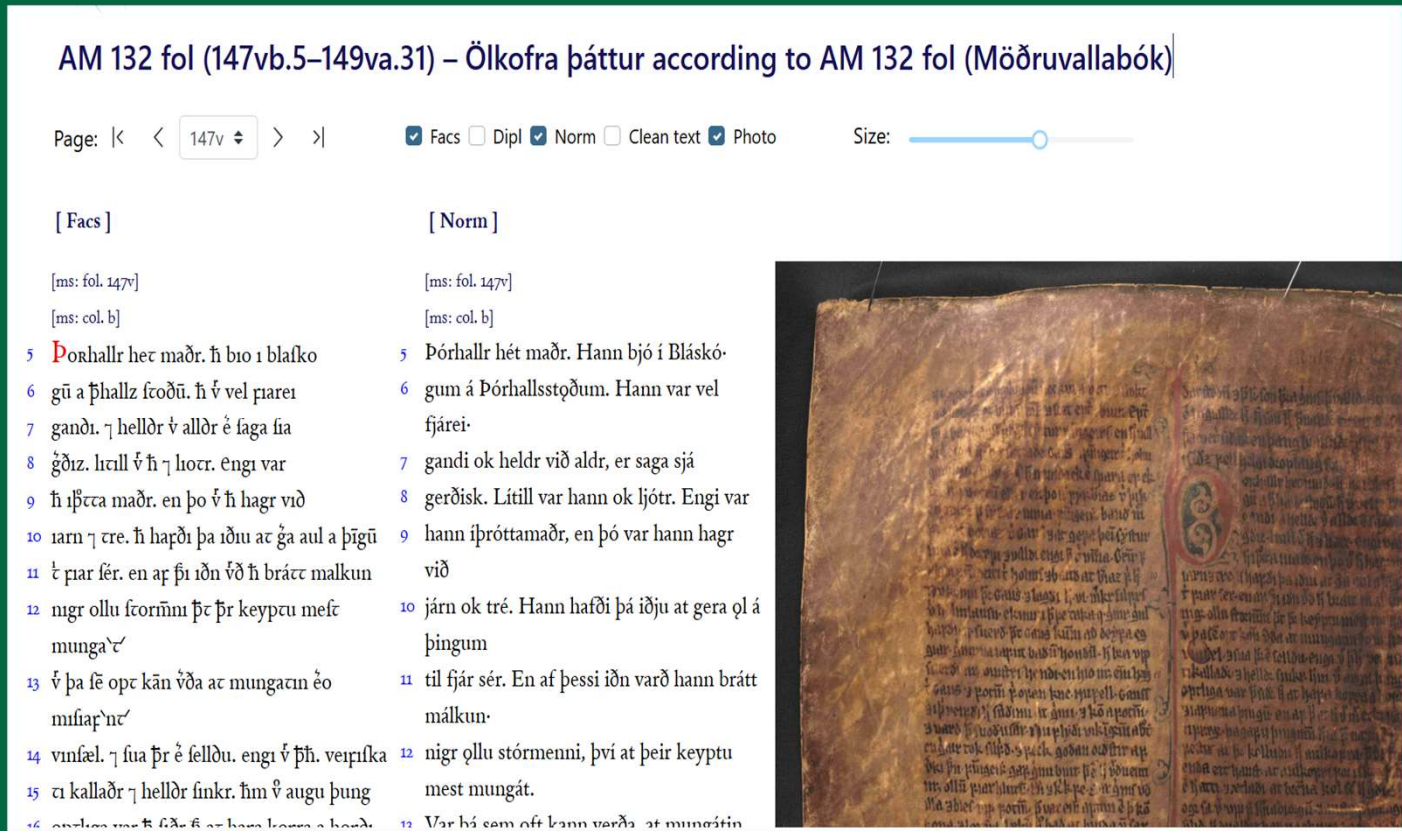
72 texts in test archive (1.159.632 words)

- 8 texts close to publication

Active use of Menota's resources

Digital transcriptions and translations

- For teaching
- For self-studying
- For research



Active use of Menota's resources

Handbook with encoding guidelines (XML)

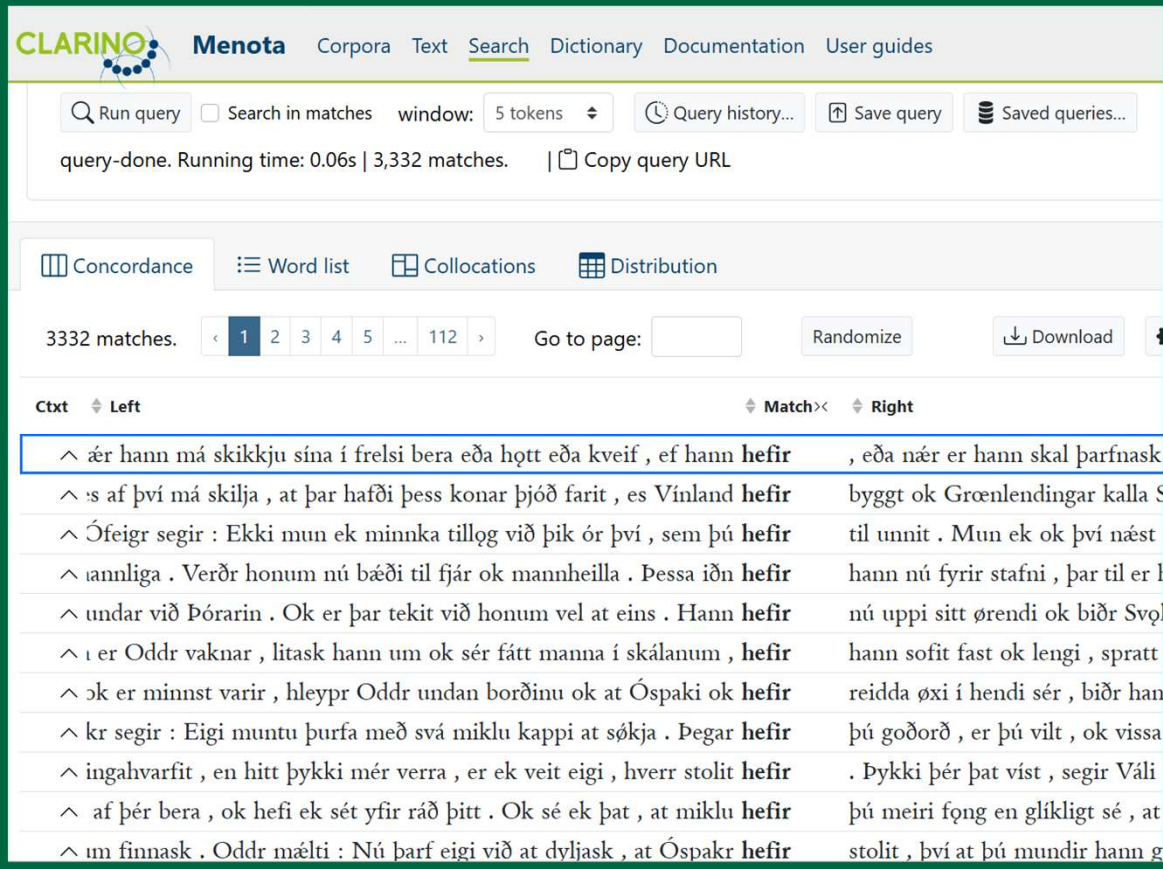
- For publication in Menota
- For publication in EAE (Editiones Arnamagnæanæ Electronicæ)
- For independent transcription projects



Active use of Menota's resources

Texts with linguistic annotation

- For search queries (across corpus or per manuscript)
- For extensions such as MenotaG and EAE



Examples: Scholarly publications

Lasse Mårtensson, Eva Pettersson and Veturliði Óskarsson. “Quantifying Medieval Scribal Habits: The Case of Abbreviations in Old West Norse Manuscripts.” *Maal og Minne* 117/1 (2025), 101-128.

Tarrin Wills. “Abbreviation in Old Norse Manuscripts – A Quantitative Study.” *Gripla* 35 (2024), 69-104.

Katarzyna Anna Kapitan and Chahan Vidal-Gorène. “Bifrost: A Handwritten Text Recognition Model for Old Norse.” Zenodo (2025). https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.15366731.

Norchron Norwegian diachronic corpus 200–1814 CE

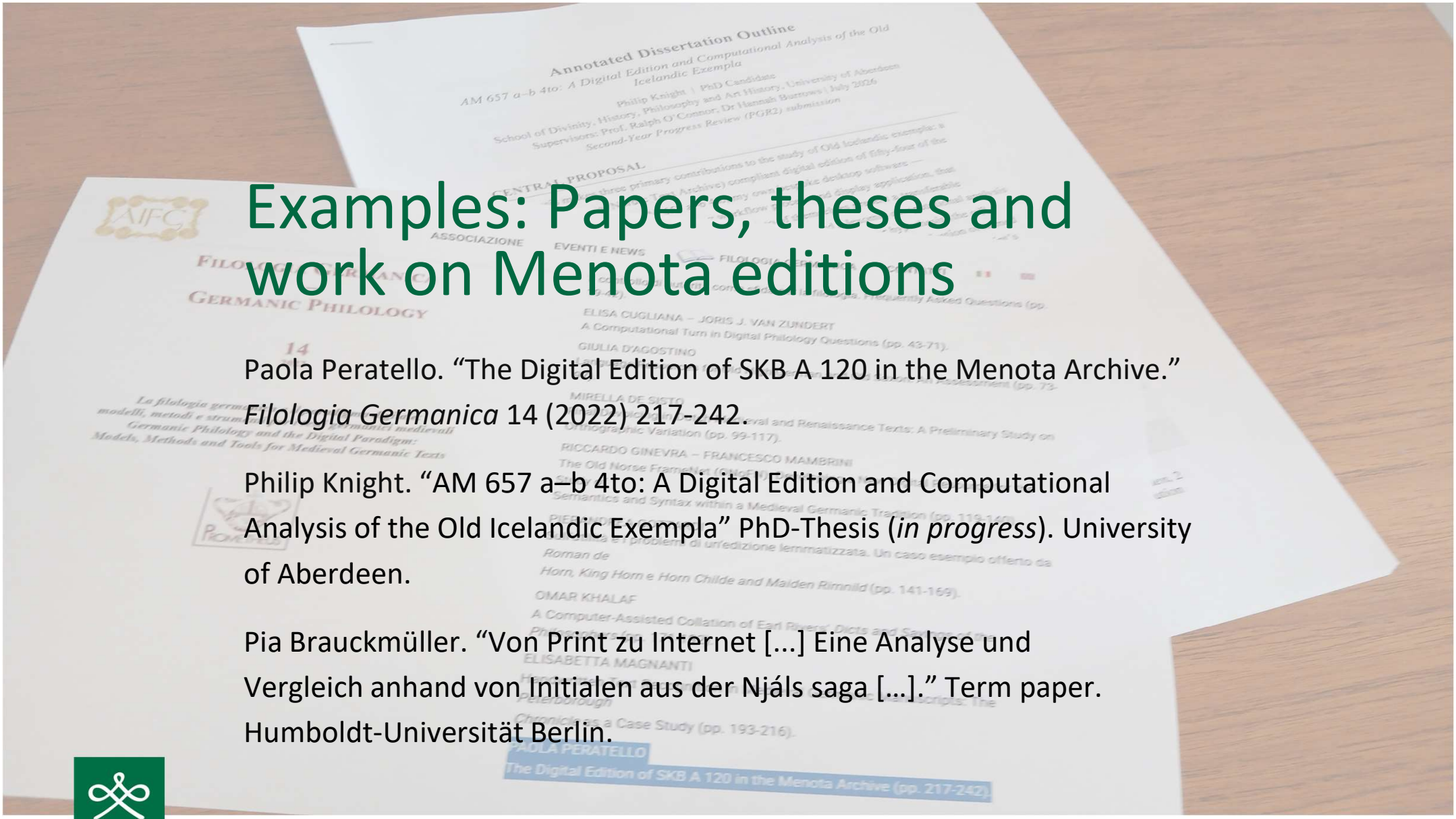
Duration 01.01.2025–31.12.2029

An ambitious initiative that will make Old Norwegian texts from between 200–1814 CE available to researchers and the public.



Examples: Research projects

Norchron: Norwegian diachronic corpus 200-1814 CE



Examples: Papers, theses and work on Menota editions

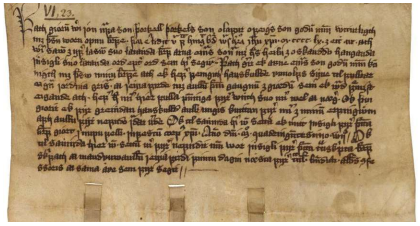
Paola Peratello. “The Digital Edition of SKB A 120 in the Menota Archive.” *Filologia Germanica* 14 (2022) 217-242.

Philip Knight. “AM 657 a–b 4to: A Digital Edition and Computational Analysis of the Old Icelandic Exempla” PhD-Thesis (*in progress*). University of Aberdeen.

Pia Brauckmüller. “Von Print zu Internet [...] Eine Analyse und Vergleich anhand von Initialen aus der Njáls saga […].” Term paper. Humboldt-Universität Berlin.

How to get published in Menota

Workflow for publication of new texts



Medieval Nordic Text Archive
www.menota.org





1st step
Transcription of text

2nd step
Contact Menota board

3rd step
Upload into test archive

4th step
Publication in main archive

Keeping a low threshold

- Flexible number of transcription levels
- Optional annotation
- No peer-review, only spot checks by board
- Help and advice as needed

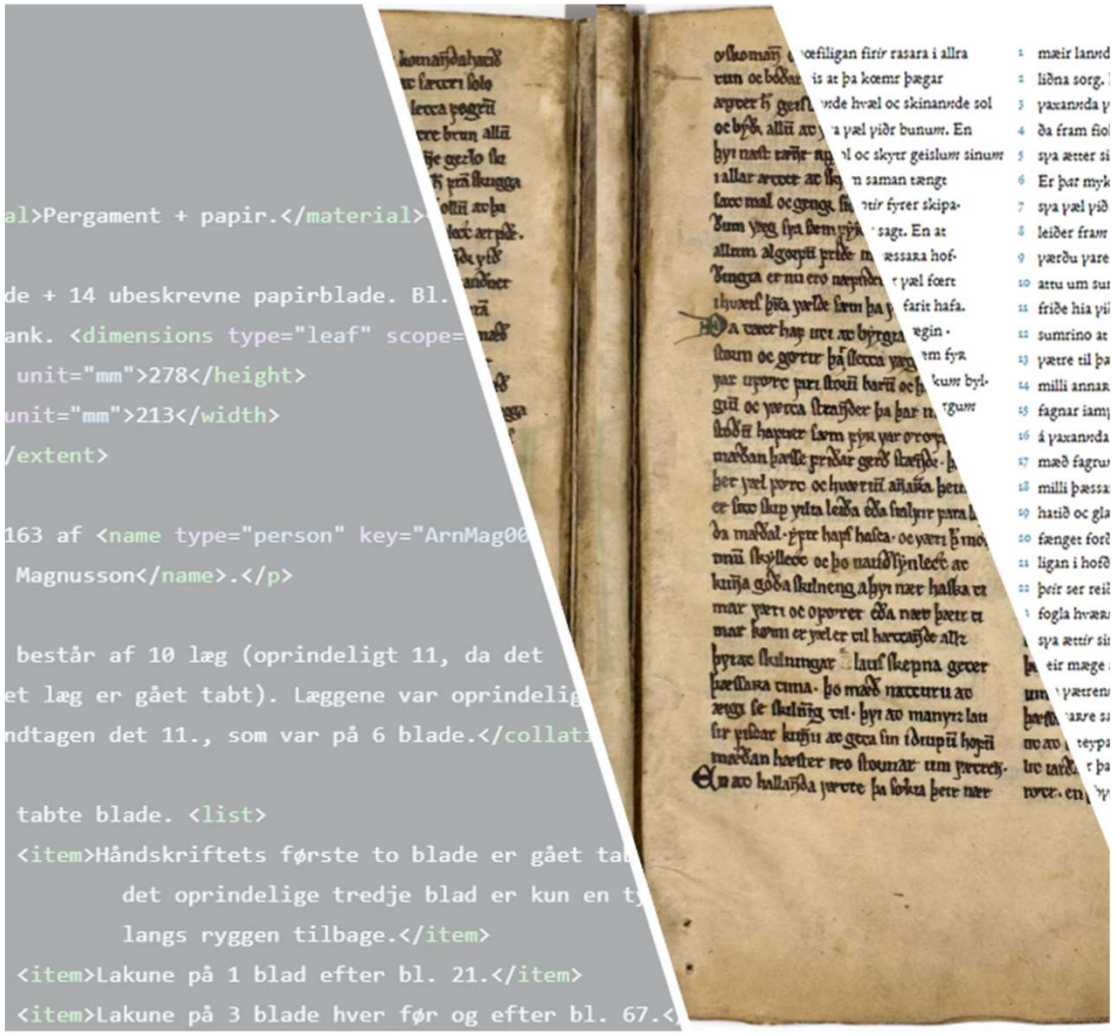


Image: Juliane Tiemann



Thoughts on the future of Menota

- Expand network to include member institutions from outside of Scandinavia

Thoughts on the future of Menota

Include young scholars

- Listen, be approachable & collaborate
- Encourage grass-root movements

Be open to and take advantage of technical advances

- Possibilities of HTR
- Menota and AI





Árnastofnun

Medieval Nordic Text Archive
www.menota.org